A Zero-Knowledge Privacy-Preserving Framework for Menstrual Phase Estimation and Athletic Strain Modulation Using Wearable Biometric Time-Series

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Abstract

Digital female health tracking has gained widespread adoption, yet existing commercial platforms function primarily as static calendar calculators, exposing sensitive reproductive data to centralized cloud databases without physiological personalization for athletic conditioning. In this paper, we present an end-to-end, privacy-preserving digital health platform that couples multi-modal time-series machine learning with client-side zero-knowledge cryptography to optimize female athletic performance and phase-synchronized nutrition. The proposed architecture employs a unified three-model machine learning pipeline: (1) a recurrent Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) network to classify menstrual cycle phase boundaries from multivariate wearable biometrics (resting heart rate, heart rate variability, and nocturnal temperature shifts), (2) an Extreme Gradient Boosting (XGBoost) regressor that modulates daily athletic strain capacity (30%–95%30%–95%) according to hormonal recovery windows, and (3) an Endocrine Recovery Kinetics & Metabolic Expenditure regressor that predicts neuromuscular recovery windows (8.0–48.0 hours8.0–48.0 hours) and dynamic TDEE caloric partitions adjusted for luteal phase thermogenesis ($+180$ kcal/day+180 kcal/day) and hepatic estrogen clearance (32 g32 g dietary fiber). To guarantee reproductive data sovereignty, all qualitative symptom notes, reflections, and images undergo client-side Authenticated Encryption with Associated Data (AES-GCM-256) with PBKDF2 key derivation ($100{,}000$100,000 iterations) prior to database persistence. Experimental benchmarks demonstrate high multi-phase sequence alignment (89.67%89.67% accuracy), robust strain modulation ($R^2 = 0.9911$R2 = 0.9911), sub-hour recovery schedule estimation (MAE 0.75 hours0.75 hours, $R^2 = 0.9878$R2 = 0.9878), sub-millisecond client encryption overhead, and an empirical database Shannon entropy > 7.98 bits/byte> 7.98 bits/byte, proving complete zero-knowledge privacy against untrusted database hosts.

Keywords: Digital Health, Menstrual Cycle Tracking, Wearable Biometrics, LSTM, XGBoost, Zero-Knowledge Encryption, AES-GCM-256, Athletic Conditioning, Sports Physiology.

I. Introduction

Female athletic conditioning has historically suffered from a significant research deficit, with foundational sports physiology paradigms predominantly derived from male athletic cohorts [1]. However, eumenorrheic females experience dramatic cyclical fluctuations in steroid hormones—primarily 17β17β-estradiol (E_2 E2) and progesterone (P_4 P4)—that profoundly modulate substrate metabolism, basal metabolic rate (BMR), thermoregulation, neuromuscular coordination, and recovery kinetics [2].

During the mid-to-late follicular and ovulatory phases, elevated estrogen concentrations facilitate hepatic glycogen sparing and enhance muscular force generation. Conversely, during the post-ovulatory luteal phase, elevated progesterone acts upon the hypothalamic thermoregulatory center, increasing basal body temperature by $0.3^\circ\text{C}–0.5^\circ\text{C}$0.3∘C–0.5∘C and elevating daily energy expenditure by $\approx 100–300\ \text{kcal/day}$≈ 100–300 kcal/day [3]. Despite these biological realities, conventional mobile health (mHealth) applications remain rudimentary calendar calculators that neglect personalized athletic strain regulation and macronutrient timing.

Concurrently, a critical privacy crisis has emerged within reproductive digital health. Commercial mobile trackers routinely store granular reproductive telemetry on centralized, unencrypted cloud databases. Recent legal and regulatory shifts have highlighted the vulnerability of centralized health databases to commercial broker monetization, third-party data tracking, and external legal discovery [4].

To overcome both limitations, this paper makes the following major contributions:

1. **A Dual-Engine Machine Learning Pipeline:** We implement a temporal PyTorch LSTM sequence classifier to predict hormonal phase boundaries from continuous wearable biometrics (HRV, RHR, sleep), paired with an XGBoost regressor that dynamically predicts daily strain capacity ($30\%–95\%$30%–95%) and recovery hours.
2. **Phase-Calibrated Metabolic Formulation:** We formulate an algorithmic dietary model that couples user biometrics (W, H, AW, H, A) and Physical Activity Level (PAL) with luteal thermogenesis ($+180\ \text{kcal/day}$+180 kcal/day), phase-scaled protein ($1.4–1.9\ \text{g/kg}$1.4–1.9 g/kg), and liver estrogen clearance fiber ($32\ \text{g}$32 g).
3. **Provable Client-Side Zero-Knowledge Cryptography:** We architect an end-to-end encrypted journal vault utilizing the browser-native Web Crypto API (AES-GCM-256 with PBKDF2 at $100{,}000$ 100,000 rounds of SHA-256). We mathematically and empirically demonstrate that raw thoughts and photos never exist in plaintext within the SQLite database, rendering host-level compromises useless.

II. Related Work

Existing cycle tracking solutions can be divided into three categories:

- **Commercial Calendar Trackers (Flo, Clue):** Primarily rely on naive calendar subtraction (e.g., Ogino-Knaus rule) assuming fixed $28$28-day cycles and $14$14-day luteal phases. These models fail in cohorts with irregular cycles and maintain unencrypted cloud storage [5].
- **Temperature Biosensors (Natural Cycles, Oura):** Ingest nocturnal temperature shifts to detect ovulation retrospectively. While scientifically valid for retrospective detection, they lack prospective athletic strain modulation and phase-specific macro computation [6].
- **General Athletic Trackers (Whoop, Garmin):** Provide sophisticated cardiovascular strain metrics based on heart rate variability (RMSSD), but their underlying proprietary algorithms completely disregard female menstrual phase transitions and associated hormonal ligament laxity or metabolic shifts [7].

Our work bridges this gap by unifying continuous wearable biosensing, athletic metabolic modeling, and mathematical zero-knowledge privacy in a single open architecture.

III. System Architecture

The framework is structured as a decoupled, privacy-first distributed architecture:



IV. Predictive Modeling & Nutritional Formulation

A. LSTM Temporal Phase Classifier

Hormone state estimation is modeled as a temporal sequence problem. Let $X = [x_1, x_2, \dots, x_t]$X = [x1, x2, ... , xt] represent a sequence of daily wearable observations, where each vector $x_t = [\text{RHR}_t, \text{HRV}_t]$ xt = [RHRt, HRVt]. Static features $S = [\text{cycle_length}, \text{day_in_cycle}]$S = [cycle_length, day_in_cycle] are concatenated at the dense projection layer:

$$h_t, c_t = \text{LSTM}(x_t, (h_{t-1}, c_{t-1}))$$

ht, ct = LSTM(xt, (ht−1, ct−1))

$$z = \text{ReLU}(W_1 [h_t ; S] + b_1)$$

z = ReLU(W1[ht; S] + b1)

$$\hat{y} = \text{Softmax}(W_2 z + b_2)$$

y^ = Softmax(W2z + b2)

Where $\hat{y} \in R^4$ y^ ∈ R4 yields the probability vector across the discrete biological phases: $\text{Menstrual, Follicular, Ovulatory, Luteal}$Menstrual, Follicular, Ovulatory, Luteal.

B. XGBoost Athletic Strain Regressor

Optimal cardiovascular strain ($Y \in [30, 95]$Y ∈ [30, 95]) is predicted via gradient-boosted decision trees over a $10$10-dimensional vector VV :

$$V = [p_{\text{menstrual}}, p_{\text{follicular}}, p_{\text{ovulatory}}, p_{\text{luteal}}, p_{\text{unknown}}, \text{HRV}, \text{SpO}_2, \text{RHR}, \text{Fatigue}, \text{Mood}]$$

V = [pmenstrual, pfollicular, povulatory, pluteal, punknown, HRV, SpO2, RHR, Fatigue, Mood]

The model optimizes an ensemble of KK regression trees:

$$\hat{Y} = \sum_{k=1}^{K} f_k(V), \quad f_k \in F$$

Y ^ = k=1∑K fk(V), fk ∈ F

Minimizing the regularized objective:

$$L = \sum_i (Y_i - \hat{Y}_i)^2 + \sum_k (\gamma T_k + \frac{1}{2}\lambda ||w_k||^2)$$

L = i∑(Yi − Y ^i)2 + k∑ (γTk + 21λ||wk||2)

C. Phase-Calibrated Nutritional Formulation

Daily caloric expenditure ($TDEE$TDEE) and nutrient partitions are computed dynamically:

1. **Basal Metabolic Rate (BMRBMR):** Using the validated Mifflin-St Jeor equation: $\text{BMR} = 10 \cdot W\ (\text{kg}) + 6.25 \cdot H\ (\text{cm}) - 5 \cdot A\ (\text{yrs}) - 161$BMR = 10 · W (kg) + 6.25 · H (cm) − 5 · A (yrs) − 161
2. **Total Daily Energy Expenditure (TDEETDEE):** $\text{TDEE} = (\text{BMR} \times \text{PAL}) + \Delta_{\text{phase}}$ TDEE = (BMR × PAL) + ΔphaseWhere Physical Activity Level (PALPAL) ranges from $1.25$1.25 (sedentary) to $1.75$1.75 (collegiate endurance runner), and: $\Delta_{\text{phase}} = \begin{cases} +180\ \text{kcal}, & \text{if phase=Luteal} \\ 0\ \text{kcal}, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$ Δphase = {+180 kcal,0 kcal,if phase = Lutealotherwise
3. **Macronutrient Targets:**
   - **Protein:** Targeted at $1.4–1.9\ \text{g/kg}$1.4–1.9 g/kg to mitigate muscular catabolism under elevated luteal cortisol.

- **Dietary Fiber:** Fixed at $32\ \text{g/day}$32 g/day during ovulatory and luteal phases to facilitate binding and fecal excretion of hepatic estrogen metabolites via sex hormone-binding globulin (SHBG) pathways.
- **Hydration:** Calculated at $35–45\ \text{mL/kg}$35–45 mL/kg plus menstrual flow volume compensation.

V. Zero-Knowledge Cryptographic Design

To ensure mathematical privacy against server-side compromise, we implement client-side Authenticated Encryption with Associated Data (AEAD):

1. **Key Derivation (PBKDF2):**
   The user supplies a local secret passphrase PP. A cryptographically secure random $16$16-byte salt $S \leftarrow U(\{0,1\}^{128})$S ← U({0, 1}128) is generated client-side:
   $K = \text{PBKDF2-HMAC-SHA256}(P, S, c = 100{,}000, L = 256)$K = PBKDF2-HMAC-SHA256(P, S, c = 100,000, L = 256)
2. **Payload Encryption (AES-GCM-256):**
   The plaintext message MM (containing title, clinical symptoms, and Base64-encoded photos) is encrypted using a random $12$12-byte initialization vector $\text{IV} \leftarrow U(\{0,1\}^{96})$IV ← U({0, 1}96):
   $C, T = \text{AES-GCM-256-Encrypt}(K, \text{IV}, M)$C, T = AES-GCM-256-Encrypt(K, IV, M) Where $T \in \{0,1\}^{128}$ T ∈ {0, 1}128 is the cryptographic authentication tag.
3. **Storage Invariant:**
   The client transmits the tuple (C, IV, S)(C, IV, S) to the FastAPI backend. At no point is the passphrase PP or derived key KK transmitted or cached server-side.

VI. Experimental Results & Benchmarks

A. Athletic Strain Modulation Across Hormonal Phases

Empirical evaluation of the trained XGBoost model under standardized resting biometrics ($\text{HRV} = 52\ \text{ms}, \text{RHR} = 58\ \text{bpm}, \text{SpO}_2 = 98\%$HRV = 52 ms, RHR = 58 bpm, SpO2 = 98%) yielded the following phase-regulated strain scores:

Menstrual Phase	Predicted Strain Score	Recommended Athletic Focus	Recovery Window
Menstrual	50%**50%**	Low-strain aerobic flush, pelvic mobility	14 hours14 hours
Follicular	75%**75%**	Progressive resistance overload, hypertrophy	10 hours10 hours
Ovulatory	85%**85%**	Maximum neuromuscular power output, PR testing	9 hours9 hours
Luteal	61%**61%**	Steady-state aerobic zone 2, technique maintenance	12 hours12 hours

The results closely align with clinical literature: maximal capacity peaks during follicular and ovulatory surges, while the luteal phase attenuates capacity to mitigate hyperthermia risk and central fatigue.

B. Endocrine Recovery Kinetics & Metabolic Predictor Benchmarks (Model 3)

Model 3 was evaluated on an unseen test cohort of $N = 1{,}200$N = 1,200 physiological profiles:

1. **Neuromuscular Recovery Hours Regressor:**
    - **Coefficient of Determination (R^2 R2):** 0.9878**0.9878** (98.78%98.78% variance explained)
    - **Mean Absolute Error (MAE):** 0.75 hours**0.75 hours** (< 45 minutes< 45 minutes)
    - **Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE):** 0.94 hours**0.94 hours**
    - **Predictions within** ±1.0 hr**±1.0 hr:** 70.9%**70.9%**
    - **Predictions within** ±2.0 hrs**±2.0 hrs:** 97.1%**97.1%**
2. **Metabolic Energy Expenditure & Macronutrient Regressor:**
    - **TDEE Energy Expenditure R^2 R2:** 0.9822**0.9822** (MAE = 20.5 kcal/dayMAE = 20.5 kcal/day)
    - **Leucine-rich Protein Allocation MAE:** 2.1 g/day**2.1 g/day**
    - **Carbohydrate Partitioning MAE:** 4.2 g/day**4.2 g/day**

Gini Feature Importance Ranking (Model 3 Recovery Hours):

```
text
#1  p_luteal                  (38.28%)  ================================
#2  training_intensity_score  (22.24%)  ==================
#3  p_menstrual               (16.23%)  =============
#4  p_follicular              ( 7.36%)  ======
#5  p_ovulatory               ( 5.18%)  ====
#6  fatigue                   ( 4.97%)  ====
#7  sleep_hours               ( 2.16%)  ==
#8  hrv_ms                    ( 2.04%)  ==
```

The Gini importance identifies post-ovulatory luteal status (38.28%38.28%) and training intensity (22.24%22.24%) as the primary drivers of physiological recovery latency, validating the clinical hypothesis that elevated progesterone thermogenesis delays muscle protein synthesis and autonomic restoration.

C. Cryptographic Latency and Database Entropy Audit

To verify that client-side encryption introduces negligible latency while guaranteeing non-recoverability, benchmarks were executed across $1{,}000$1,000 iterations:

- **PBKDF2 Derivation Overhead:** 24.2 ± 3.1 ms24.2 ± 3.1 ms
- **AES-GCM Payload Encryption (Text + 960px Image):** 8.4 ± 1.2 ms8.4 ± 1.2 ms
- **Decryption & De-serialization:** 6.1 ± 0.9 ms6.1 ± 0.9 ms
- **Shannon Entropy of Database Ciphertext:** 7.989 bits/byte7.989 bits/byte (approaching theoretical maximum of $8.0$8.0, confirming uniform cryptographic randomness).

A string-matching audit executed directly against the SQLite database confirmed zero substring matches for user medical reflections, proving the absolute absence of plaintext leakage.

VII. Discussion & Limitations

While the current framework demonstrates the efficacy of privacy-preserving menstrual athletic intelligence, two limitations warrant discussion:

1. **Biometric Ingestion:** Currently, wearable data is ingested via standardized API/CSV formats. Future work will integrate the Web Bluetooth API for direct BLE telemetry streaming from commercial smart rings.
2. **Biomarker Ground Truth:** Model evaluation utilized retrospective self-reported cycle logs paired with wearable temperature shifts. Clinical validation against urinary LH surge strips and

serum progesterone (P_4 P4) panels remains the designated next phase.

VIII. Conclusion

We have presented an integrated, privacy-first framework for female athletic health and menstrual phase optimization. By unifying an LSTM temporal phase sequence classifier, an XGBoost strain regressor, dynamic metabolic macronutrient formulation, and client-side zero-knowledge AES-GCM-256 cryptography, the proposed system demonstrates that personalized, hormone-synchronized sports conditioning can be achieved with zero corporate data surveillance.

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